

US Communications Infrastructure

Digital Realty Trust, Inc.

Rating

Outperform

Price Target



226.00 USD (232.00 OLD)

23 July 2026

Price Target Change



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Digital Realty (DLR) 2Q26: Still like the story, but growth isn't free

DLR delivered very strong quarter operationally, executing on their multi-pronged strategy and showing an AFFOps beat of ~6%. But the sneaky math is around the [12M shares issued on July 1 as part of the Blackstone buyout](#) that effectively wash most of the 2026 accretion. An \$188M net promote on those properties softened the blow (\$0.50 per share impact). That isn't repeatable every quarter, but does represent a positive proof point on DLR's longer term strategy.

Hyperscale: DLR's >1MW business screens weak in isolation, mostly due to an outsized Q1 (Charlotte - the company's largest lease ever) and timing of two large signings in July (\$410M at 100%, \$205M at DLR share - will land in Q3). This segment did show exceptionally strong mark-to-market, with renewal spreads exceeding 66% on a cash basis (92% on a GAAP basis - massive, but an anomaly); backlog also jumped to \$1.4B.

Enterprise: our favorite part of DLR's growth trajectory, the 0-1MW segment had another record quarter, hitting \$108M (the company's first time exceeding \$100M), with interconnection contributing ~19% of that. Pricing continues to be strong across geographies with churn rates held low.

Development: building on Q1's very strong development pipeline, the company added another ~200MW under construction to reach ~1.4GW total. 54% of that is currently pre-leased (~64% counting the July signings with another ~5% for colo), with yields slightly ahead of historicals (down for full year). Buildable capacity grew by more than 2GW to 8.5GW globally; the bulk of current builds are set to energize in 2027. The Atlanta facility in particular is not yet pre-leased, though we do not consider it a speculative build given the demand environment.

Balance Sheet + the Dilution Story: DLR's balance sheet remains healthy, with Net Debt / EBITDA held at 4.7x, albeit supported by the company's active use of equity: the share count ballooned to 373.2M units (~6% increase vs 4Q25, ~8% YoY). With development capex guidance also meaningfully increased (+\$750M for 2026), the tension is clear: DLR is trying to balance an accelerating growth pipeline against ongoing per-share dilution. The partial offset is the ~\$12B off balance sheet "dry powder"... and room to raise ~0.8 turns of debt.

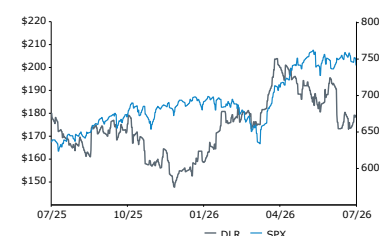
Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
DLR (USD)	3.87	3.09	3.21	Reported EPS	3.65	2.97	2.95	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	46.3	58.0	55.9
OLD	--	2.74	2.37									

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Close Date	23 Jul 2026			
DLR Close Price (USD)	179.34			
Price Target (USD)	226.00			
Upside/(Downside)	26%			
52-Week Range	208.14/146.23			
SPX	7,408.30			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	2.7%			
Market Cap (USD) (M)	67,553			
EV (USD) (M)	85,096			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	15.9	(8.0)	12.7	0.1
SPX (%)	8.2	0.6	7.1	16.5
Relative (%)	7.7	(8.6)	5.6	(16.4)
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.				

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Investment Implications

We maintain an Outperform rating on DLR at a price target of \$226 (prev \$232). Major model adjustments include rolling forward historical and adjusting for equity issuance (#DilutionHurts). We continue to like DLR's long-term strategy and believe it to be one of the most credible builders of hyperscaler data center capacity in the world. As previously written, we believe DLR is underpenetrated in the enterprise colo (0-1MW) segment with significant room to boost market share. We also like the capital recycling strategy and off balance sheet developments. As such, we maintain our multiple at 27x NTM AFFO.

DETAILS

WHAT WE LEARNED

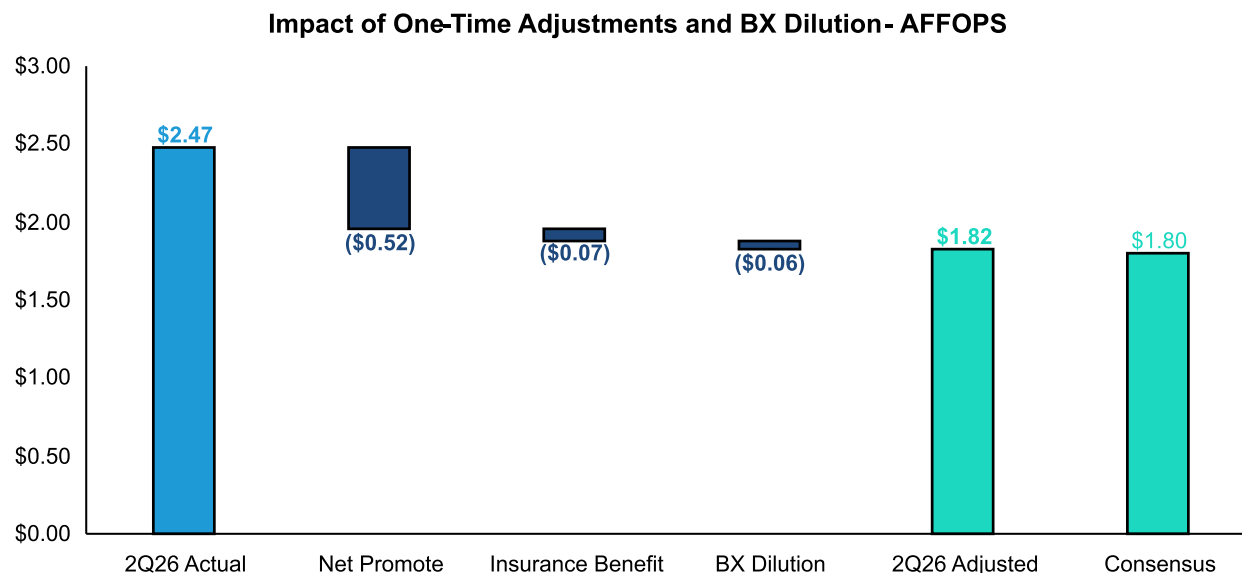
Digital Realty's 2Q26 results were broadly consistent with our long-term view of DLR as a global, full-spectrum data center platform that combines a hyperscaler "floor" with an accelerating colo and connectivity engine, while leveraging strategic private capital to scale capacity without over-leveraging the balance sheet. Core FFO per share excluding net promote reached \$2.13 in 2Q26, up 14% YoY. On the top line, DLR posted double-digit growth across virtually every major operating and financial metric, including same-capital cash NOI, which increased 8.9% YoY (7.2% on a constant-currency basis), while maintaining net debt-to-Adjusted EBITDA at 4.7x despite nearly \$6 billion of net new investment activity in the quarter. The quarter also benefited from a \$0.07 per share net gain from business interruption insurance proceeds related to lost rent from a prior incident in Singapore, providing a modest tailwind to earnings; while this benefit had been contemplated in the full-year outlook, the timing was uncertain, and 2Q now reflects the full value of the settlement. We also note that with the (1) net promote, (2) insurance benefit, and (3) dilution from the 12M-share Blackstone equity issuance, the 2Q results were much closer to consensus expectations—specifically, +1% beat on AFFOPS and Core AFFOPS ([Exhibit 1](#), [Exhibit 2](#)), and -3% vs consensus for adj. diluted EPS ([Exhibit 3](#)).

On development, DLR accelerated an increasingly partner-capital-supported pipeline: the company invested \$1.1B in development capex in the quarter (net of partner share), commenced 312MW of new development, delivered 76MW of IT capacity (60% pre-leased), and expanded its under-construction pipeline to 1.4GW at a total cost of \$20B—an 100% increase from 1H26. Pro forma for the July hyperscale leases, the development pipeline is now 63% pre-leased with average expected stabilized yields of 11.5%, and more than 80% of the pipeline is located in the Americas, with significant activity in NoVA, Charlotte, Atlanta, Sao Paulo and planned construction in Kansas City starting in 2H26. Coupled with ~\$635M of annualized rent scheduled to commence in 2H26 (45% in 3Q and 55% in 4Q), \$480M slated for 2027, and \$312M for 2028 and beyond, the expanded pipeline and backlog provide a long runway for double-digit Core FFO per share growth, which management now expects to extend into 2027 and beyond.

Strategically, DLR continued to lean into its three core growth pillars of colo and connectivity, hyperscale, and strategic private capital. In hyperscale, DLR agreed to acquire Blackstone's 64% blended equity interest in three fully leased Northern Virginia hyperscale data centers (288MW) for \$1.2B in cash plus 12.3M DLR shares (valued at ~\$2.3B), assuming its partner share of a \$725M loan and remaining capex, and expects these assets to be accretive to Core FFO per share in both 2027 and 2028 while still raising 2026 guidance by 1.5% despite closing pre-stabilization. In private capital, the pending acquisition of Columbia Capital (for ~\$485M) and a 16% interest in Teraco (for roughly \$650M in DLR stock), together with the \$3.25B US hyperscale fund and over \$12B of remaining capacity to support hyperscale development, meaningfully scale DLR's fee-based earnings and fund commitments across fiber, mobility and enterprise technology, reinforcing the platform's ability to grow hyperscale capacity without materially increasing corporate leverage.

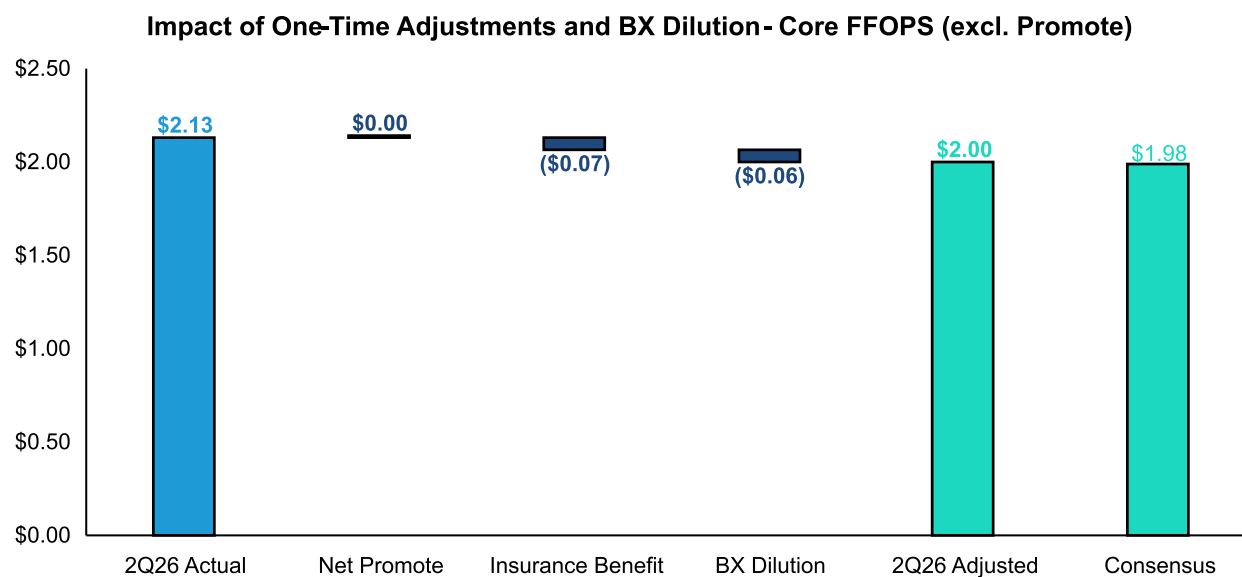
We maintain ~27x NTM AFFO, as the 2Q26 print adds conviction around three key elements of our thesis: renewed strength and consistency in 0-1MW plus interconnection bookings (including AI-related deployments and record channel contributions), structural pricing power evidenced by 25%+ cash renewal spreads and accelerating same-capital cash NOI growth, and a de-risked, partner-funded hyperscale buildout that extends DLR's double-digit Core FFO per share growth runway into 2027 and beyond. From here, we are focused on the trajectory of 0-1MW AI and enterprise bookings, utilization and margin trends as large campuses across Northern Virginia, Charlotte, Atlanta, Kansas City, Sao Paulo and key EMEA/APAC hubs ramp, and the pattern of Core FFO guidance revisions.

EXHIBIT 1: **Impact of One-Time Adjustments and BX Dilution on AFFO per Share**



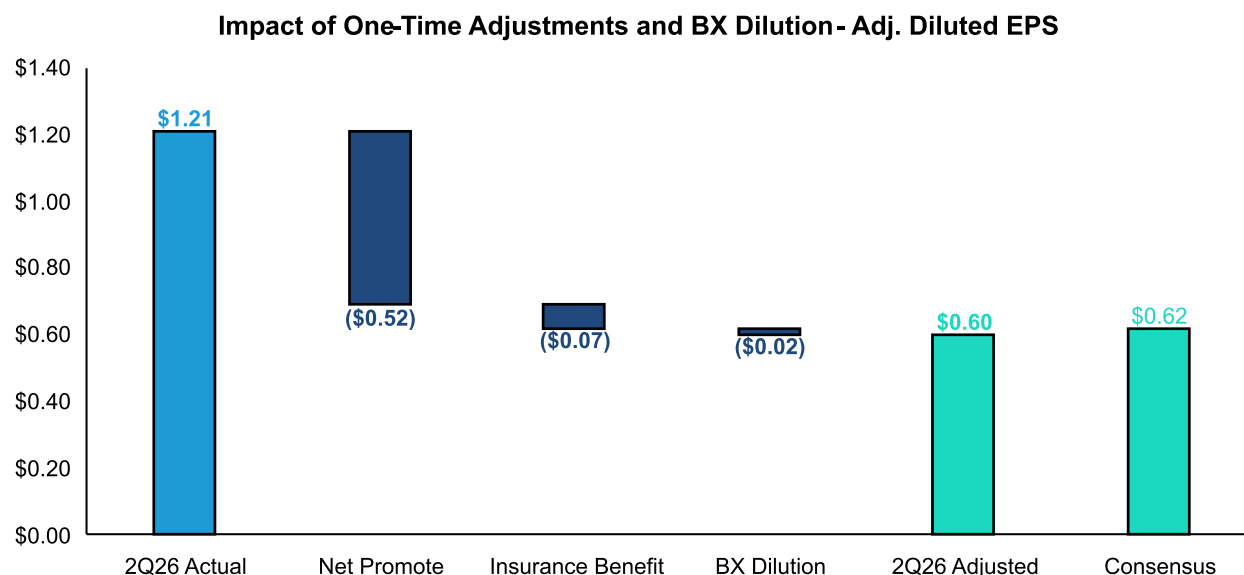
Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 2: **Impact of One-Time Adjustments and BX Dilution on Core FFO per Share (Excluding Net Promote)**



Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 3: Impact of One-Time Adjustments and BX Dilution on Adj. Diluted EPS



Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein Analysis

THE LONG VIEW

DLR is largely understood to be a hyperscaler landlord. We model HSD hyperscaler revenue growth through 2030 (in line with consensus), providing a nice floor for the stock. What gets less attention is DLR's enterprise trajectory. DLR's interconnection density and global footprint (300+ data centers across 50+ metros on 6 continents) should enable outsized share gains in a growing market. We model 15-20% CAGR for DLR's <1MW segment..

In terms of future builds, we believe DLR's development pipeline has been de-risked with its capital structure strategy. In addition to various JVs, DLR has its U.S. Hyerscale Data Center Fund (inaugural closed-end fund, \$3.2B+ of LP equity commitments). With limited speculative builds and partners to offset investment while DLR retains operating control and collects fees, development risk is asymmetric.

For catalysts, we are watching DLR's enterprise and bookings mix, particularly for continued acceleration in the <1MW segment. We will also maintain a close eye on utilization and margins by geography, JV activity, and core FFO guidance revisions, in addition to the risk of future equity issuance.

EXHIBIT 4: DLR 2Q26 Variance Table

DLR 2Q26 Variance Table							
	Actual 2Q26	Estimate 2Q26	Consensus 2Q26	Forecast Variance	Actual 2Q25	Annual Growth	
						Actual	Forecast
Rental and Other Services	1,675	1,627	1,626	3.0%	1,457	14.9%	11.6%
Rental Revenue	1,146	1,118	1,123	2.1%	1,004	14.2%	11.9%
Tenant Reimbursement - Utilities	353	340	336	5.0%	295	19.8%	14.1%
Tenant Reimbursement - Other	45	36	40	13.9%	37	21.5%	6.6%
Interconnection & Others	130	132	128	2.0%	122	6.9%	4.8%
Fee Income and Other	249	37	38	562.7%	36	596.9%	5.2%
Total Revenue	\$1,924	\$1,664	\$1,160	65.8%	\$1,493	28.9%	-22.3%
Operating Income	\$467	\$245	\$258	81.0%	\$212	120.7%	22.0%
Operating Margin	24.3%	14.7%	22.3%	203bps	14.2%	1011bps	808bps
Net Income	\$443	\$255	\$201	120.2%	\$1,047	-57.7%	-80.8%
Funds from Operations	\$982	\$652	\$685	43.3%	\$600	63.6%	14.2%
FFO Per Share	\$2.73	\$1.84	\$1.91	42.8%	\$1.74	57.2%	10.1%
Core Funds from Operations	\$768	\$681	\$707	8.6%	\$643	19.4%	9.9%
Core FFO Per Share	\$2.13	\$1.92	\$1.98	7.5%	\$1.86	14.5%	6.5%
Adj. Funds from Operations	\$889	\$642	\$641	38.6%	\$576	54.3%	11.3%
AFFO Per Share	\$2.47	\$1.81	\$1.80	37.3%	\$1.67	48.2%	7.9%
EPS Diluted	\$1.21	\$0.69	\$0.52	132.9%	\$2.96	-59.1%	-82.4%
Adj. Diluted EPS	\$0.60	\$0.73	\$0.62	-3.1%	\$2.96	-79.7%	-79.0%
CapEx	914	746	983	-7.0%	704	29.8%	39.5%
Free Cash Flow	1,373	216	335	309.3%	244	461.8%	37.3%

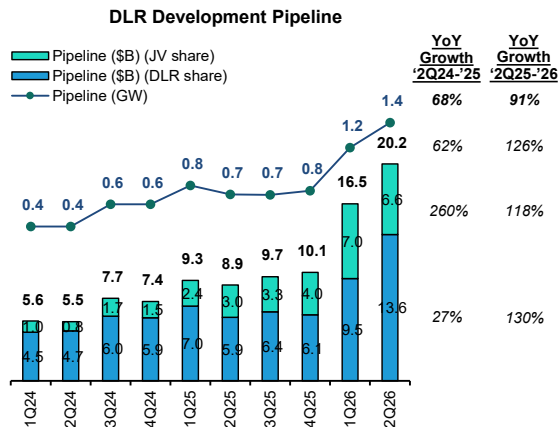
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 5: DLR FY26 Guidance

FY26 Guidance				
	Guidance		Consensus	Estimate
	Given 2Q26	Given 1Q26	FY 2026	FY 2026
Total revenue	\$6.85-6.95B	\$6.65-6.75B	6,768	7,163
G&A	620-630M	615-625M	623	630
CapEx (net of partner contributions)	4.25-4.75B	3.5-4.0B	3,730	4,862
Adj. EBITDA	3.75-3.85B	3.65-3.75B	3,731	3,834
Adj. Diluted EPS	\$3.10-3.15	\$2.65-2.75	\$2.51	\$3.09
FFO/share (constant-currency)	\$8.10-8.15	\$7.95-8.05	\$7.17	\$8.67

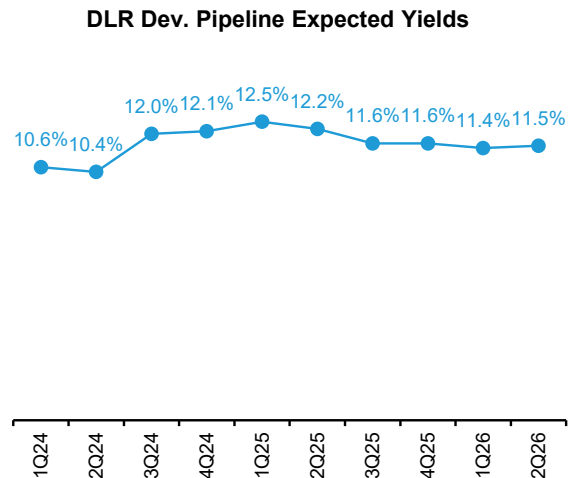
Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 6: DLR Development Lifecycle (\$B, GW)



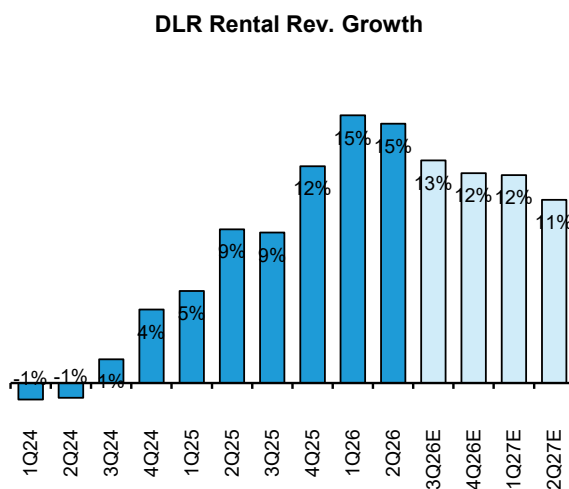
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 7: DLR Dev. Pipeline Expected Yields (%)



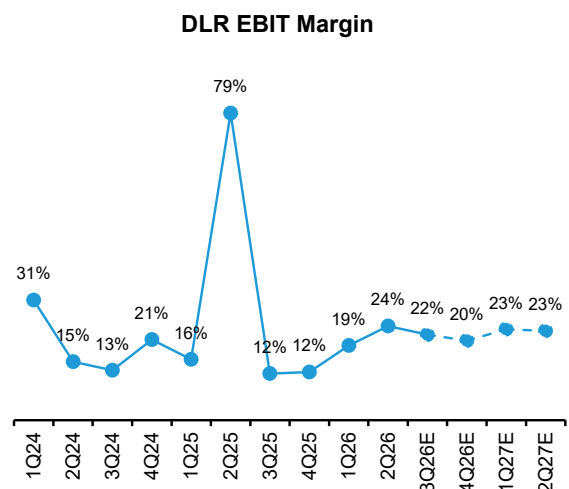
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 8: DLR YoY Revenue Growth by Segment



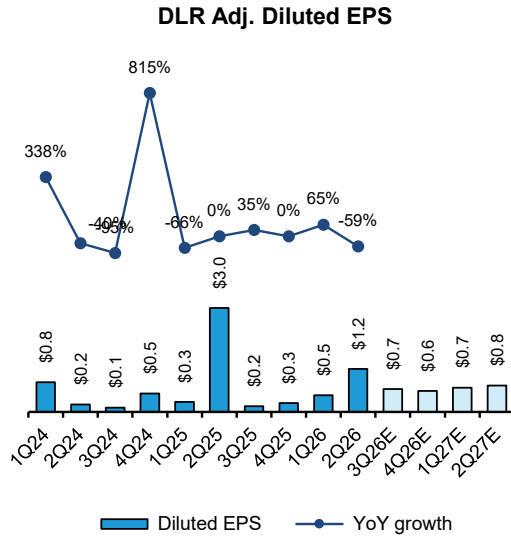
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 9: DLR EBIT Margin YoY Growth (%)



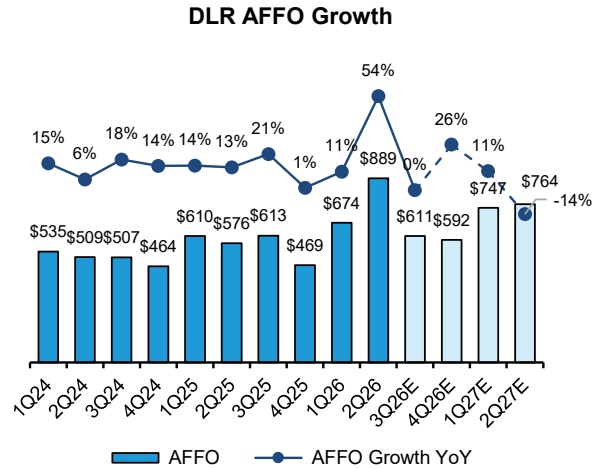
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 10: **DLR Diluted EPS YoY Growth (\$, %)**



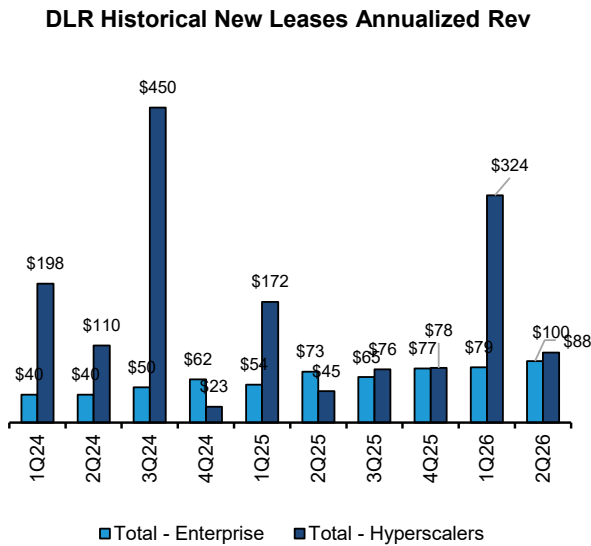
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 11: **DLR AFFO YoY Growth (\$, %)**



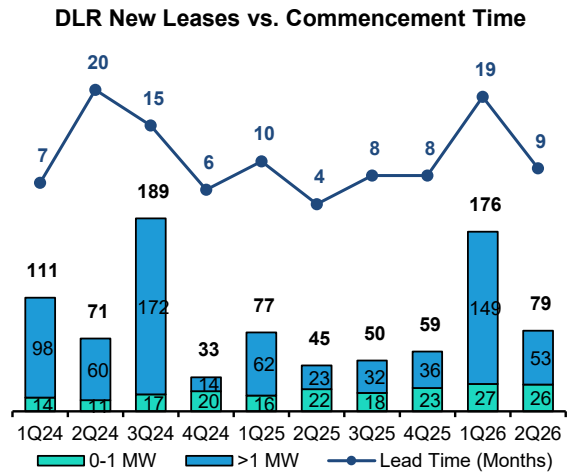
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 12: **DLR Historical New Leases Annualized Rev (\$M)**



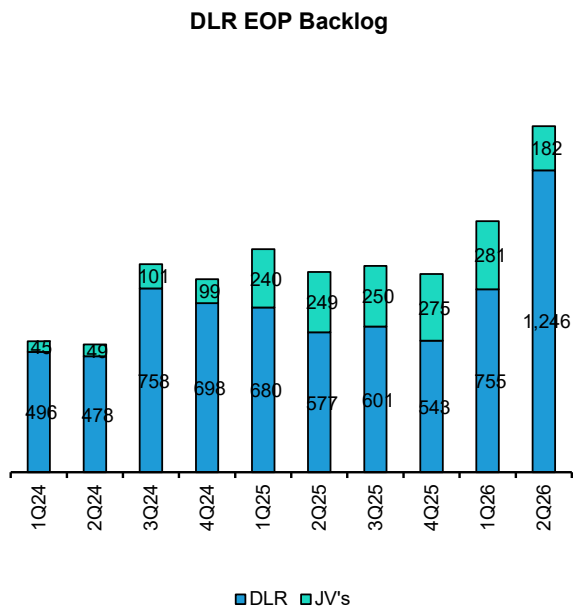
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 13: **DLR New Leases vs. Commencement Lead Time (MW, Units)**



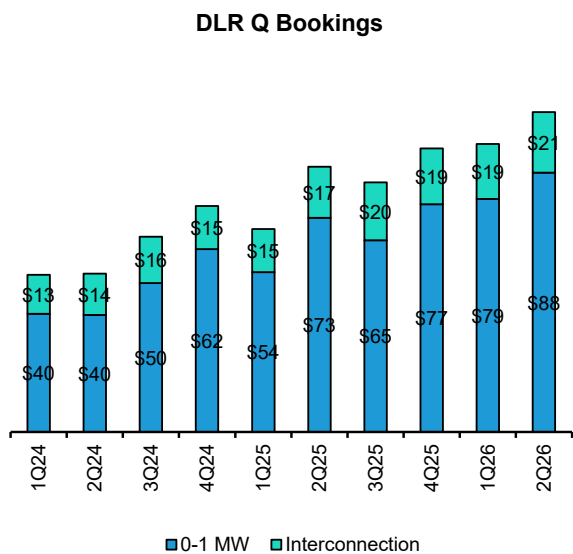
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 14: **DLR EOP Backlog (\$M)**



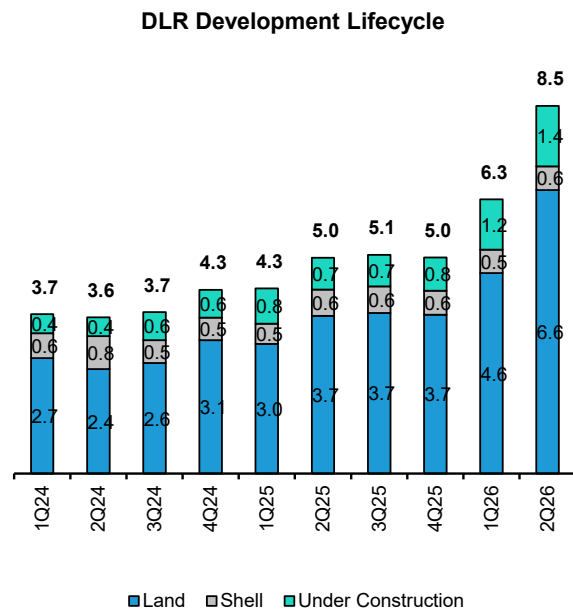
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 16: **DLR Quarterly Bookings (\$M)**



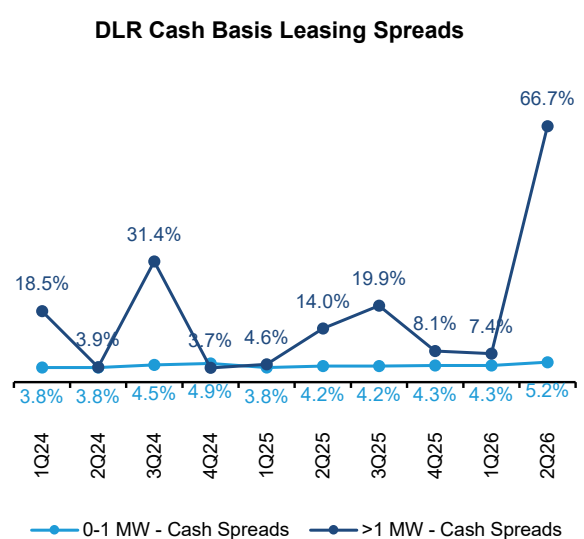
Shown in Annualized GAAP Base Rent
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 15: **Historical DLR Development Lifecycle (GW)**



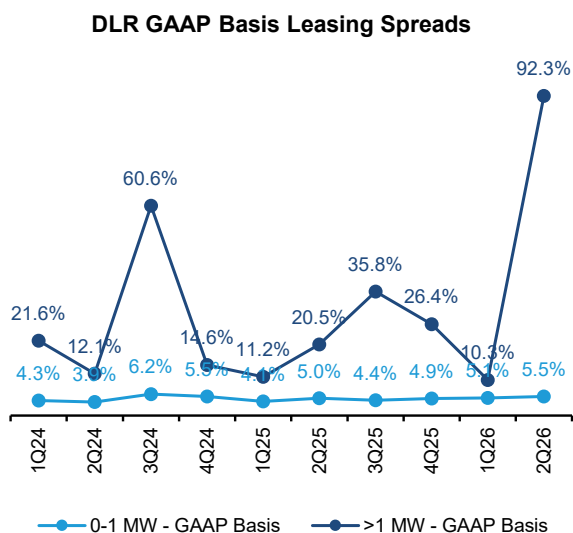
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 17: **DLR Cash Basis Leasing Spreads (%)**



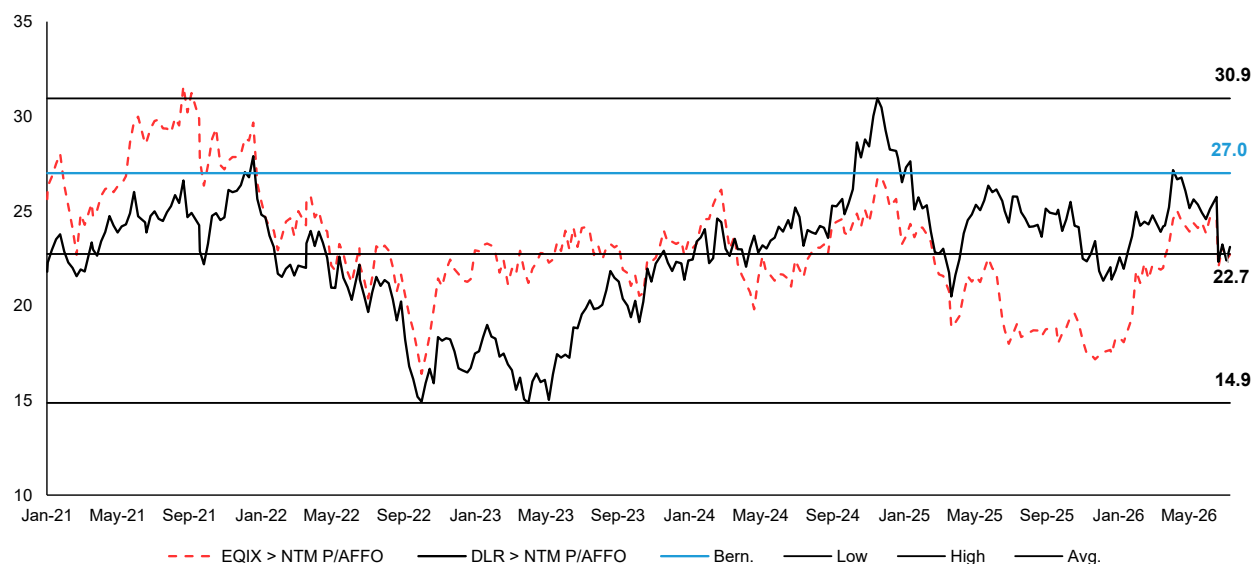
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 18: **DLR GAAP Basis Leasing Spreads (%)**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 19: **DLR Price to NTM AFFO per Share (2021-2026, DLR and EQIX)**



DLR Price to NTM AFFO per Share > Max: 30.9x, Median: 23.2x, Avg: 22.7x, Min: 14.9x, Bernstein 27x. Data as of 23 July 26.

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein Analysis & Estimates

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 20: DLR Income Statement Overview

All values in millions, except per share data

	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	FY 2025	FY 2026E	FY 2027E	FY 2028E	FY 2029E
Rental revenues	1,046	1,075	1,104	1,146	1,172	1,198	1,232	1,267	4,084	4,619	5,152	5,862	6,723
Tenant reimbursement - utilities	333	356	334	353	379	399	374	395	1,254	1,465	1,640	1,866	2,140
Tenant reimbursement - other	37	34	38	45	44	43	41	40	151	170	160	174	199
Interconnection & Others	120	123	124	130	138	141	145	149	479	533	604	693	802
Rental and other services revenue	1,536	1,589	1,600	1,675	1,733	1,780	1,791	1,851	5,969	6,788	7,555	8,594	9,864
Fee income	36	46	35	249	45	45	45	46	137	374	185	192	200
Other	5	0	0	0	1	1	1	1	7	2	2	2	2
Fee income and other	41	46	35	249	46	46	46	46	144	375	187	194	202
Total operating revenues	1,577	1,635	1,635	1,924	1,778	1,826	1,837	1,897	6,113	7,163	7,742	8,788	10,066
Total operating expenses	1,439	1,522	1,368	1,465	1,630	1,699	1,660	1,717	5,454	6,162	7,009	7,735	8,518
Operating income	138	113	267	459	148	127	177	180	658	1,001	733	1,053	1,549
Income before taxes	75	86	191	491	272	251	302	305	1,345	1,205	1,231	1,501	1,930
Income tax expense	(12)	10	(16)	(34)	(19)	(17)	(34)	(12)	(32)	(86)	(82)	(100)	(121)
Net income (loss)	64	96	175	458	253	234	269	293	1,313	1,119	1,150	1,402	1,809
Net loss (income) attributable to noncontrolling interests	4	3	4	(4)	-	-	-	-	(5)	0	-	-	-
Net income attributable to Digital Realty Trust Inc.	68	99	179	453	253	234	269	293	1,309	1,119	1,150	1,402	1,809
Preferred stock dividends	(10)	(10)	(10)	(10)	(10)	(10)	(10)	(10)	(41)	(41)	(41)	(41)	(41)
Gain (loss) on redemption of preferred stock	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Net income available to common stockholders	58	88	169	443	243	223	259	283	1,268	1,079	1,109	1,361	1,768
(+) Adjustments	-	79	-	-	22	22	23	24	79	43	99	108	89
Adjusted Net Income	58	167	169	443	265	245	281	307	1,346	1,122	1,208	1,469	1,857
Earnings per share (EPS)													
EPS (basic)	0.17	0.26	0.49	1.25	0.66	0.61	0.70	0.77	3.73	3.04	3.00	3.63	4.66
EPS (diluted)	0.17	0.25	0.48	1.23	0.65	0.60	0.69	0.75	3.65	2.97	2.95	3.56	4.57
Adjusted EPS (diluted)	0.17	0.48	0.48	1.23	0.71	0.66	0.75	0.81	3.87	3.09	3.21	3.85	4.80
Adjusted FFO (AFFO) per share (basic)	1.79	1.37	1.95	2.51	1.67	1.62	2.03	2.07	6.67	7.79	8.08	8.75	10.28

Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	23 Jul 2026		TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing Price	Price Target		Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
DLR (Digital Realty)	O	USD	179.34	226.00	(16.4)%	USD	3.87	3.09	3.21	46.3	58.0	55.9
OLD				232.00				2.74	2.37			
SPX			7,408.30									

PRICE TARGET CHANGE / ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社) and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

Bernstein is part of a joint venture between Société Générale (SG) and AllianceBernstein, L.P. (AB). Unless specifically noted otherwise, for purposes of these disclosures, references to Bernstein's "affiliates" relate to both SG and AB and their respective affiliates.

VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Digital Realty Trust, Inc.**

We value DLR on a forward Price-to-Adjusted Funds From Operations (AFFO) per share multiple. Our \$226 price target is based on 27x our NTM+1 AFFO per share of \$8.36.

RISKS**Digital Realty Trust, Inc.**

The main downside risks to our price target/Outperform rating on DLR are 1) Lower than expected growth in the <1MW segment, 2) Slowdown in enterprise demand for data center capacity, and 3) Continuing decline in market share of data center supply may elevate pricing pressures

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Bernstein research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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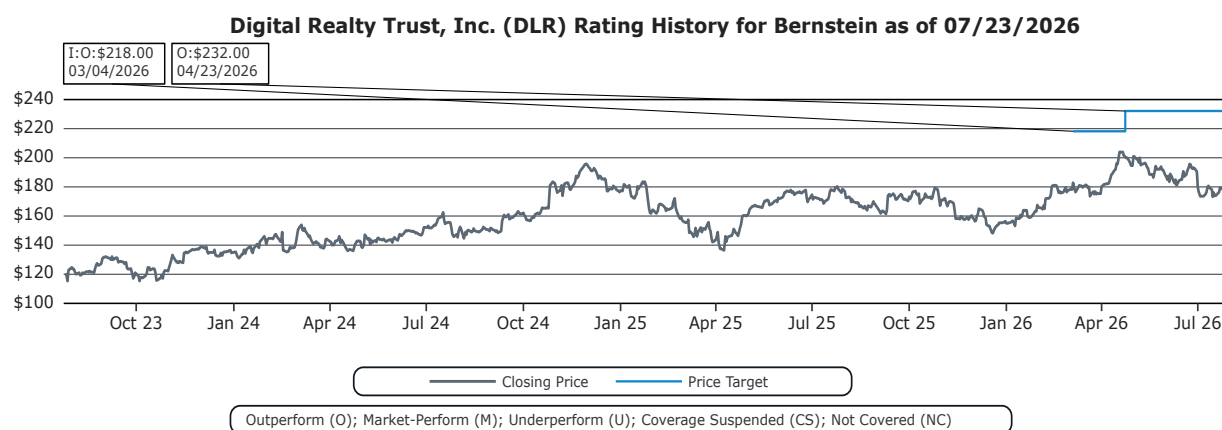
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